Middle East Israel wanted— and needed—to strive toward after the chaos died down.

Since then and up to the time of completing this book (in late 2017), the world and the Middle East have undergone many changes and upheavals. But all these changes do not negate the central idea of this section, which proposes that the "good guys" outline what the day after should look like in order to help shape the plans that are being put together. It must be understood that the Middle East is witnessing changes that are similar in scope to the Sykes-Picot Agreement, which lasted for a hundred years!

Back in 2015, the Israeli and international media were full of editorials and opinion pieces by various pundits that grappled with the dilemma between security and morality in the context of the Western democracies' approach to fighting ISIS. My personal, somewhat Machiavellian view was that if we chose morality over security with regard to the enemy in question, then what we would achieve would be dying with the proud knowledge that we had died as more moral beings.

Russia is fighting ISIS, but it is clear to all that what is more important to it than defeating that terrorist group is its aspiration to firmly establish its military presence in Syria and preserve the regime of Bashar al-Assad. To a great extent, this is also true of Iran, which, in addition to its desire to uphold Assad's regime, aspires to create a continuum of territorial influence from Iran to the Mediterranean (the "Shia Crescent"). In my estimation, the Western democracies would have been capable of dealing with ISIS and bringing about its elimination, even without Russian and Iranian assistance, if they had demonstrated determination and perseverance in this mission.

Achieving the goal of destroying ISIS requires integrated air and ground force activity. The aerial activity is already in place at the time of the writing of this chapter, but it is not sufficiently intensive or effective. The only effective ground activity is that of the Iraqi Kurds, but it is also not sufficient.

I believe that the following elements, if realized, can lead to ISIS's defeat:

- A joint command and control center must be established by the United States, France, and other NATO members (Britain? Turkey?) whose main task is to come up with targets based on all of the partners'